

3.4.2 Modifying the Shape of the Selections

Not only can you add and subtract from selections (as mentioned before), but you can also expand and contract them as you please. You can find these options under **Select > Modify**.

The **Border** option turns the selection into a border around the area you selected—all you need to do is specify the thickness of the border.

The **Smooth** option irons out sharp edges from the selection. The larger the value of **Sample Radius** you give it, the more smoothing it will apply to the selection.

The **Expand** and **Contract** options are quite self-explanatory—just enter the number of pixels and see the final results.

We saw earlier that you can feather selections through the option bar; you can also feather selections using **Select > Feather** and specifying the feather amount. Remember, feathering selections will cause some loss of detail in the selection boundary.

To alter the size of the selection, use the **Select > Transform Selection** option. This will give you a rectangular box around the selection, which you can use to scale, distort or skew the selection.



Copying and moving selections around—use [Ctrl] and [Alt] to copy (left) and just [Ctrl] to move